Experiment-1

1. Brainstorming

During the initial brainstorming phase, our team openly discussed real-world challenges observed in daily life to explore potential startup concepts. Each team member pitched ideas addressing specific market gaps, evaluating them for feasibility, social relevance, and growth potential

1. Women Entrepreneurs Network

   This idea focused on creating a platform that brings women entrepreneurs together and provides them with the support needed to start and grow their businesses. The platform would provide access to mentors, funding opportunities, networking, business promotion, workshops, and useful resources. It would especially help women who may have good business ideas but face difficulties in finding guidance, financial support, customers, or the right connections.

2. Local Artisan & Handmade Goods Marketplace

   This idea focused on creating an online marketplace for local artisans, craftsmen, and small creators to showcase and sell their handmade products. The platform would give them greater visibility and help them reach customers beyond their local area. Customers would also be able to discover unique, locally made products while supporting small businesses and individual creators.

3. Freelance Skills Marketplace for Students

   This idea focused on creating a platform where students could offer their skills and find freelance projects based on their abilities. Students with skills such as graphic design, content writing, coding, video editing, or social media management could connect with individuals and small businesses looking for such services. This would give students an opportunity to gain practical experience while earning through their skills.

4. Neighbourhood Volunteering Platform

   This idea focused on connecting people who want to volunteer with NGOs, local organisations, and community activities in their neighbourhood. Users could find volunteering opportunities based on their interests and availability, while organisations could find people willing to help with different

activities. The main aim was to make volunteering easier to discover and encourage greater participation in local communities.

5. Home-Based Food Delivery & Review Platform

This idea focused on helping people who run home-based food businesses reach customers in their local area. Home chefs and small food businesses could list their menus and make their food available to nearby customers. Customers could discover different homemade food options, place orders, and provide ratings and reviews, helping both customers and home-based food sellers build trust.

2.Ideation

Proposed Business/Startup Idea: Women Entrepreneur Network (WEN)

The Women Entrepreneur Network is a comprehensive, end-to-end digital ecosystem developed to address the foundational barriers faced by women founders, solopreneurs, and small business owners. While many women possess viable, innovative business concepts, they frequently encounter structural bottlenecks—namely constrained access to working capital, an absence of accessible mentors, weak customer discovery pipelines, isolated professional networks, and skill deficits in financial and digital management.

The platform unites founders, industry veterans, financial institutions, investors, and non-profits into a single, cohesive interface. Rather than functioning as a passive social directory, it operates as an active growth catalyst offering integrated operational support:

Problem Context & Market Opportunity: Women-owned enterprises represent a rapidly expanding segment of the MSME and startup landscape, yet an overwhelming majority remain undercapitalized and restricted to hyper-local or informal operations. Existing platforms cater primarily to broad corporate careers or general social networking, leaving early-stage and micro-scale women founders without tailored, transactional business support. The platform bridges this gap by democratizing access to capital pipelines, vetted advisory, and direct sales infrastructure.

Core Functional Pillars:

- **Direct Mentorship Ecosystem:** Facilitates structured, 1-on-1 connections with experienced industry leaders and founders to deliver practical guidance on scaling, compliance, and product strategy.
- **Funding & Capital Navigation:** Aggregates discovery channels for angel investments, commercial bank loans, micro-credit programs, and targeted government schemes (such as Stand-Up India and Mudra).
- **Digital Commerce & Visibility Storefront:** Integrates an in-app product and service showcase enabling women-run home ventures and small businesses to expand their reach and acquire verified B2B and B2C customers.

- **Collaborative Peer Community:** An active network that allows founders to cross-promote services, share resources, form partnerships, and exchange operational best practices.
- **Skill Development & Masterclasses:** Regular interactive workshops covering critical operational topics, including digital marketing, tax compliance, cash-flow management, and investor pitch preparation.
- **Target Audience:**
- Aspiring female entrepreneurs and college students looking to commercialize an early idea.
- Home-based business owners and solopreneurs aiming to scale into registered, sustainable ventures.
- Experienced professionals, investors, banking partners, and NGOs seeking measurable avenues to mentor, fund, and support women-led businesses.

Revenue Model: Anyone can join the platform for free to connect with others, so there is no barrier for early-stage founders to get started. To make money and sustain operations, the platform charges a ₹199 per month subscription for members who want direct one-on-one mentor sessions, advanced workshops, and priority event access. In addition, the business earns a small commission on every product or service sold through the in-app storefront, along with sponsorship funds from banks, corporate brands, and NGOs that back startup events and training workshops.

3. **Mind Map** To visualise how the Women Entrepreneurs Network idea branches into actionable areas, the group created the mind map below. It places the core idea at the centre, with the major support pillars radiating outward, and specific action points attached to each pillar.

